



Dolby's more than just cinema sound

◀ Ashim Mathur, Vice President of Marketing (Asia Pacific), Dolby Laboratories

From audio to video, smartphones and cars, Dolby's evolving faster than ever before

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Dolby's presence in India stretches back two to three decades, initially concentrated on the world of film and the immersive audio that became synonymous with their brand. However, the establishment of a formal operational base around 2009-2010 marked a significant turning point, remembers Ashim Mathur, Vice President of Marketing (Asia Pacific), Dolby Laboratories and a key figure in Dolby's India operations.

"Back in those days, HD was just entering the Indian market," recalls Mathur. "From both a screen and broadcast perspective, the shift to HD was a big moment, and we were right there, partnering with broadcasters and enabling a wide array of HD channels with Dolby surround sound. That was really our starting point". This early engagement laid the foundation for Dolby's deeper integration into the Indian entertainment fabric.

The Atmos revolution

A pivotal moment arrived around 2012 with the launch of Dolby Atmos in Indian cinemas, debuting at the Satyam Theatre in Chennai. This wasn't

merely an incremental upgrade to existing sound systems; it was a paradigm shift towards object-based audio, creating a truly three-dimensional soundscape that captivated audiences.

"Since then, we haven't looked back," Mathur states, highlighting the rapid adoption of Atmos, which now graces over a thousand screens across the country. The impact of Atmos extended beyond cinemas, quickly finding its way into living rooms, mobile devices, and even automobiles, showcasing Dolby's ambition.

Building an ecosystem

Dolby's success in India hasn't been coincidental. Mathur outlines a comprehensive three-pronged strategy for the entire content ecosystem: creation, distribution, and devices.

On the creation front, Dolby has worked closely with filmmakers, TV channels, music composers, and post-production professionals, ensuring they have the tools and expertise to craft content that leverages Dolby's technologies. Recognizing India's linguistic diversity, this support extends across multiple languages and regional content industries.

The second pillar, distribution, involves collaborating with set-top box manufacturers, OTT platforms, and music streaming services to ensure

that Dolby-enhanced content reaches consumers seamlessly. This collaborative effort ensures that the investment in high-quality creation is matched by accessible delivery mechanisms.

Democratizing premium

As Dolby technologies become more prevalent across different device categories and price points, particularly with Dolby Vision now accessible on more affordable televisions, the focus shifts towards ensuring a consistently high-quality experience.

Looking ahead, Dolby is keenly focused on expanding into new domains, notably the automotive sector through a partnership with Mahindra. The integration of Dolby Atmos into vehicles promises to transform the in-car entertainment experience, aligning with consumers' growing expectations for high-quality audio across all their devices. "Once people start experiencing Dolby Atmos in vehicles, especially in the Indian context, it's going to fundamentally change the way in-car entertainment is perceived," predicts Mathur.

When asked to summarize Dolby's mission in India, Mathur offers a concise yet encompassing vision: "Our mission is to unlock the power of sight and sound to create spectacular experiences. In India, that means going deep and wide," **■**

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